FINAL HONOUR SCHOOL OF
PHILOSOPHY, POLITICS AND ECONOMICS (PPE):
INTERNAL EXAMINERS' REPORT
2017

This report was updated on 13 February 2020 to correct statistics in Part A, 1-2 and 5. The report is in three sections: Part A – Statistics; Part B – Chair's Comments; Part C – Comments on Individual Papers (Politics only).

PART A: Statistics

1. Class distribution of FHS candidates

Class	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012	2011
1st	**54** **22.7%**	38 16.4%	55 22.1%	51 20.6%	70 29.3%	47 19.3%	57 24.8%
2.1	**170** **71.4%**	179 77.2%	183 73.5%	188 76.1%	153 64.0%	188 77.0%	162 70.4%
2.2	**12** **5.0%**	15 6.5%	11 4.4%	6 2.4%	16 6.7%	9 3.7%	10 4.3%
3rd	**2** **0.8%**	0	0	2 0.8%	0	0	0
Honours Pass	**0**	0	0	0	0	0	1 0.8%
Fail	**0**	0	0	0	0		0
Total	**238**	**232**	**249**	**247**	**239**	**244**	**230**

2. Statistics by Sex and Ethnicity

a. Class Distributions by Sex (%)

Class	2017		2016		2015		2014		2013		2012		2011	
	F	M	F	M	F	M	F	M	F	M	F	M	F	M
1st	**18.4**	**24.7**	14.5	17.4	10.6	28.0	17.1	22.4	27.6	30.1	16.7	20.5	27.2	22.8
2.1	**72.4**	**71.0**	80.7	75.2	85.9	67.1	82.9	72.7	67.1	62.6	79.5	75.9	68.9	71.7
2.2	**7.9**	**3.7**	4.8	7.4	3.5	4.9	0	3.6	5.3	7.4	3.8	3.6	3.9	4.7
3rd	**1.3**	**0.6**	0	0	0	0	0	1.2	0	0	0	0	0	0
Honours Pass	**0**	**0**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.8
Fail	**0**	**0**	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

b. Overall Statistics by Sex

	2017		2016		2015		2014	
	M	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**	**M**	**F**
Total Candidates	162 68.1%	76 31.9%	150 65.1%	82 34.9%	165 66.3%	84 33.7%	165 66.8%	82 33.2%
Average Mark	65.2	64.3	65.5	65.1	65.6	64.5	65.4	65.1
Standard Deviation	6.8	6.9	6.3	5.5	6.3	5.5	4.3	3.2

c. Class Distributions by Ethnicity

	2014/15*			2013/14			2012/13		
	White	**BME**	**Unknown**	**White**	**BME**	**Unknown**	**White**	**BME**	**Unknown**
1st	41 24%	9 19%	1 9%	35 21%	9 14%		38 21%	9 17%	1 5%
2.1	122 72%	34 72%	10 91%	126 74%	51 78%	2 100%	132 73%	39 74%	17 85%
2.2	6 4%	3 6%		8 5%	5 8%		10 5%	5 9%	2 10%
3rd		1 2%		1 1%					
Total	169	47	11	170	65	2	182	53	20

(Source = Annual Programme Statistics, Departmental Report)

*most recent year available when the report was published. The year refers to the year in which students commenced study, not the year in which the exams were taken.

3. Statistics by Paper

'Code' in the table below refers to each paper's number in the Examination Regulations; each paper's name and number are listed in section 4 below. Where different papers share a code, the initials of the paper name are given in brackets.

Code	**Candidates**	**>= 70**	**>= 60**	**>= 50**	**>= 40**	**>= 30**	**< 30**	**Upper Quartile**	**Median**	**Lower Quartile**	**Mean Mark**	**St.Dev.**
101	43	12%	81%	7%	0%	0%	0%	67.0	65.0	63.5	65.1	3.5
102	64	17%	59%	22%	2%	0%	0%	69.0	66.0	60.8	64.7	5.7
103	151	13%	68%	19%	1%	0%	0%	67.0	64.0	61.0	63.6	5.4
104	6	33%	67%	0%	0%	0%	0%	69.5	64.5	61.0	65.8	5.5
106	9	0%	100%	0%	0%	0%	0%	65.0	64.0	63.0	64.3	1.6
107	25	12%	84%	4%	0%	0%	0%	68.0	66.0	64.0	66.2	3.0
108	9	33%	56%	11%	0%	0%	0%	71.0	67.0	63.0	66.0	5.9
109	26	12%	77%	12%	0%	0%	0%	66.0	63.0	60.0	63.4	4.6

110	1											
112	4										68.0	1.2
113	24	33%	63%	4%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	66.5	65.0	66.8	3.6
114	37	22%	70%	8%	0%	0%	0%	69.0	66.0	65.0	66.2	4.5
115	39	18%	72%	10%	0%	0%	0%	67.5	66.0	63.5	65.6	4.9
116	24	8%	83%	8%	0%	0%	0%	68.3	65.5	63.0	65.1	3.7
117	3										64.3	2.1
118	15	20%	73%	7%	0%	0%	0%	68.5	67.0	64.0	66.2	4.4
119	1											
122	2											
124	5	60%	40%	0%	0%	0%	0%	72.0	71.0	65.0	68.4	4.1
127	13	23%	54%	23%	0%	0%	0%	67.0	64.0	61.0	64.6	5.4
150	8	25%	75%	0%	0%	0%	0%	69.5	67.5	66.8	67.6	2.7
199	12	25%	67%	8%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	67.5	64.8	68.4	6.3
201	51	24%	61%	14%	2%	0%	0%	68.0	67.0	62.0	65.1	5.7
202	72	32%	47%	15%	6%	0%	0%	71.0	67.5	60.0	65.3	7.9
203	93	18%	67%	13%	1%	1%	0%	68.0	65.0	62.0	64.6	6.3
204	18	22%	72%	6%	0%	0%	0%	68.5	65.0	62.0	65.4	4.6
205	23	26%	65%	9%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	65.0	62.0	66.0	4.9
206	5	20%	80%	0%	0%	0%	0%	68.0	64.0	63.0	65.4	3.1
207	9	33%	56%	0%	0%	0%	11%	70.0	67.0	66.0	63.6	12.9
208	22	32%	59%	5%	5%	0%	0%	70.0	67.0	64.0	66.9	6.2
209	6	17%	67%	17%	0%	0%	0%	67.8	64.5	60.5	64.3	5.6
210	9	44%	44%	11%	0%	0%	0%	73.0	69.0	64.0	68.0	6.0
211	32	19%	81%	0%	0%	0%	0%	68.3	66.5	65.0	66.8	3.1
212	8	38%	63%	0%	0%	0%	0%	70.3	67.5	65.0	67.5	4.0
213	30	17%	77%	7%	0%	0%	0%	67.8	66.0	64.0	65.7	3.8
214	120	22%	63%	13%	1%	0%	1%	69.0	66.0	61.8	65.1	7.9
215	22	23%	64%	14%	0%	0%	0%	69.0	65.5	63.0	65.3	4.8
216	20	30%	55%	15%	0%	0%	0%	70.3	64.5	63.0	65.3	5.6
217	20	25%	65%	10%	0%	0%	0%	68.5	65.0	63.0	66.1	4.5
218	13	31%	62%	8%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	69.0	67.0	67.8	4.1
219	4										64.8	0.8
220	62	23%	66%	10%	0%	0%	2%	69.0	65.5	62.0	65.6	9.5
223	4										66.8	3.9
224	16	25%	56%	13%	6%	0%	0%	68.8	62.5	60.0	62.9	8.3
225	3										70.7	6.0
226	1											
227	14	29%	57%	14%	0%	0%	0%	69.5	67.0	64.3	65.6	5.9
228	4										72.3	1.1
229	16	50%	38%	13%	0%	0%	0%	70.3	69.5	63.8	67.3	5.0
297 (CPE)	10	20%	80%	0%	0%	0%	0%	68.8	67.5	67.0	68.8	3.7
297 (ISC)	18	44%	44%	11%	0%	0%	0%	71.0	67.5	65.0	67.1	4.9
298	9	78%	22%	0%	0%	0%	0%	73.0	73.0	71.0	71.7	3.5

299	21	57%	33%	10%	0%	0%	0%	73.0	70.0	64.0	68.8	7.1
300	143	29%	32%	24%	10%	3%	1%	70.5	63.0	54.0	61.8	11.8
301	152	21%	64%	14%	1%	0%	1%	68.0	66.0	62.0	64.5	6.6
302	154	31%	47%	18%	3%	1%	0%	70.0	65.0	60.0	64.6	8.0
303 (MA)	11	55%	9%	18%	9%	0%	9%	73.0	71.0	56.0	61.3	17.3
303 (MT)	1											
304	15	27%	73%	0%	0%	0%	0%	69.0	67.0	66.0	67.1	2.9
305	20	20%	75%	5%	0%	0%	0%	67.3	65.5	65.0	65.8	3.9
306	19	21%	63%	16%	0%	0%	0%	67.5	65.0	61.5	65.1	5.3
307 (222)	13	15%	54%	31%	0%	0%	0%	66.0	62.0	59.0	63.2	4.7
308	6	17%	67%	17%	0%	0%	0%	67.8	66.0	61.3	64.5	4.6
310	34	32%	68%	0%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	67.5	64.0	67.1	3.4
311	7	29%	71%	0%	0%	0%	0%	69.5	68.0	67.0	69.1	4.0
314	18	22%	39%	22%	11%	6%	0%	68.5	66.0	53.5	61.1	10.4
318	9	0%	100 %	0%	0%	0%	0%	65.0	65.0	63.0	64.6	1.3
319	13	31%	46%	15%	0%	8%	0%	70.0	68.0	64.0	64.8	12.2
320	5	40%	60%	0%	0%	0%	0%	70.0	67.0	62.0	67.8	5.9
321 (126)	8	38%	63%	0%	0%	0%	0%	71.0	67.0	64.8	68.1	4.3

4. Numbers Offering Each Paper

The total number of papers provided in the 2017 Final Honour School of PPE was 72.

a. Philosophy

Philosophy	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**	**2011**
101. Early Modern Philosophy	**43**	38	49	50	44	63	71
102. Knowledge and Reality	**64**	77	75	60	55	38	17
103. Ethics	**151**	145	154	158	152	155	139
104. Philosophy of Mind	**6**	20	14	21	18	14	8
106. Philosophy of Sci. and Soc. Sci.	**9**	7	1	8	3	6	9
107. Philosophy of Religion	**25**	26	38	46	32	32	30
108. Philosophy of Logic and Lang.	**9**	15	18	10	18	12	20
109. Aesthetics	**26**	26	17	15	15	22	14
110. Medieval Philosophy: Aquinas	**1**	0	2	2	3	1	N/A
112. The Philosophy of Kant	**4**	8	5	8	7	6	5
113. Post-Kantian Philosophy	**24**	11	22	25	21	19	11
115. Plato: Republic	**39**	38	39	40	39	56	51
114. Theory of Politics (203)	**37**	31	34	37	38	38	47
116. Aristotle: Nicomachean Ethics	**24**	9	28	20	19	30	35
117. Frege, Russell, and Wittgenstein	**3**	0	2	0	2	1	1
118. The Later Philosophy of Witt.	**15**	11	9	9	10	16	4
119. Set Theory, Logic	**1**	1	0	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
122. Philosophy of Mathematics	**2**	2	1	0	0	0	0
124. Philosophy of Science	**5**	1	4	2	5	2	2
125. Philosophy of Cognitive Science	**0**	5	4	4	2	1	N/A
127. Philosophical Logic	**13**	13	5	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

150. Jurisprudence	**8**	9	6	5	7	7	9
199. Thesis	**12**	10	9	8	8	4	5

b. Politics

Politics (PPE)	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012	2011
201. Comparative Government	**51**	64	67	88	69	78	83
202. BPG since 1900	**72**	60	67	57	48	47	55
203. Theory of Politics (114)	**93**	95	98	108	114	109	93
204. Modern British Gov. and Pol.	**18**	24	15	18	18	14	23
205. Gov. and Pol. of the US	**23**	20	17	27	24	24	22
206. Politics in Europe	**5**	5	7	10	15	15	19
207. Pol. in Russia and the Fmr USSR	**9**	5	12	11	9	6	N/A
208. Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa	**22**	28	24	36	34	42	34
209. Politics in Latin America	**6**	9	11	9	11	14	15
210. Politics in South Asia	**9**	7	9	12	9	13	16
211. Politics in the Middle East	**32**	35	32	38	31	38	29
212. IR in the Era of Two World Wars	**8**	3	16	15	14	19	20
213. IR in the Era of the Cold War	**30**	25	23	32	34	34	57
214. International Relations	**120**	115	135	135	124	143	124
215. Pol. Thought: Plato to Rousseau	**22**	19	22	20	18	29	23
216. Pol. Thought: Benth. to Weber	**20**	16	17	22	23	29	24
217. Marx and Marxism	**20**	9	15	14	18	15	10
218. Sociological Theory	**13**	21	10	24	14	21	10
219. The Soc. of Post-Indust. Soc.	**4**	17	7	3	2	N/A	N/A
220. Political Sociology	**62**	76	61	58	61	71	60
223. The Gov. and Politics of Japan	**4**	0	3	2	0	1	4
224. Social Policy	**16**	28	33	27	16	14	25
225. CDS (pre-2016 see 315)	**3**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
226. Quant. Meth. in Pol. and Soc.	**1**	5	6	3	2	4	3
227. Politics in China	**14**	18	13	20	23	24	16
228. The Politics of the EU	**4**	2	11	8	10	8	9
229. Adv. Paper in Theories of Just.	**16**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Comp. Pol. Economy	**10**	19	21	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Int. Secu. and Conflict	**18**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
298. Supervised dissertation	**9**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
299. Thesis	**21**	23	15	24	18	30	22

Politics (History and Politics)	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012	2011
201. Comparative Government	7	5	13	16	10	7	20
202. BPG since 1900	16	12	14	16	16	12	18
203. Theory of Politics (114)	19	26	15	19	20	23	27
204. Modern British Gov. and Pol.	1	5	3	5	5	2	4
205. Gov. and Pol. of the US	1	5	4	5	5	3	12
206. Politics in Europe	2	1	2	1	2	0	4
207. Pol. in Russia and the Fmr USSR	1	3	3	2	1	0	N/A
208. Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa	5	5	5	4	2	4	10
209. Politics in Latin America	1	2	0	1	2	0	1
210. Politics in South Asia	0	3	0	1	3	5	4
211. Politics in the Middle East	8	9	8	9	12	9	9

212. IR in the Era of Two World Wars	2	2	5	1	3	1	5
213. IR in the Era of the Cold War	3	9	6	6	7	4	6
214. International Relations	25	35	26	30	29	24	42
215. Pol. Thought: Plato to Rousseau	2	5	4	2	2	4	1
216. Pol. Thought: Benth. to Weber	3	2	2	10	3	5	6
217. Marx and Marxism	3	3	1	3	4	4	5
218. Sociological Theory	1	2	2	0	4	1	0
219. The Soc. of Post-Indust. Soc.	1	1	1	2	1	N/A	N/A
220. Political Sociology	9	16	12	12	18	12	17
223. The Gov. and Politics of Japan	0	1	0	1	0	0	0
224. Social Policy	5	5	3	5	3	2	4
225. CDS (pre-2016 see 315)	0	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
226. Quant. Meth. in Pol. and Soc.	0	0	0	1	1	0	0
227. Politics in China	5	2	1	3	4	3	2
228. The Politics of the EU	1	2	1	2	4	1	0
229. Adv. Paper in Theories of Just.	2	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Comp. Pol. Economy	1	1	0	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
297. SS in Pol.: Int. Secu. and Conflict	4	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
298. Supervised dissertation	1	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
299. Thesis	11	11	8	9	7	13	13

c. Economics

Economics	**2017**	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**	**2011**
300. Quantitative Economics	**143**	138	150	141	144	151	135
301. Macroeconomics	**152**	144	156	146	150	151	135
302. Microeconomics	**154**	146	157	146	150	151	135
303. Microeconomic Theory	**1**	12	11	15	25	28	20
303. Microeconomic Analysis	**11**	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
304. Money & Banking	**15**	11	10	12	12	19	6
305. Public Economics	**20**	16	21	25	17	37	32
306. Economics of Industry	**19**	11	15	8	8	17	12
307. Labour Econ. and Ind. Rel. (222)	**13**	7	13	13	13	14	17
308. International Economics	**6**	4	11	8	8	20	21
310. Economics of Devel. Countries	**34**	29	23	27	32	32	45
311. British Econ. History since 1870	**7**	8	7	6	6	18	15
314. Econometrics	**18**	13	32	27	21	23	28
315. Comp. Demog. Systems (225)	**N/A**	6	4	3	4	8	2
318. Finance	**9**	N/A	N/A	0	1	15	9
319. Game Theory	**13**	12	25	23	30	37	27
320. Mathematical Methods	**5**	31	33	11	17	16	12
321. Phil. & Econ. of the Envir. (126)	**8**	9	16	7	7	N/A	N/A
399. Thesis	**0**	2	2	0	1	0	1

5. Statistics by Branch

For joint papers, two paper codes exist to distinguish candidates taking the paper under one branch from candidates taking the paper under the other. Scripts were allocated to the relevant branch accordingly. The three separate assessments for Jurisprudence candidates are counted as one

Philosophy script. Set Theory and Logic are counted as one Philosophy script. 'Subjects' in the next two tables comprise scripts, theses, and supervised dissertations.

a. Approximate percentages of subjects in each branch:

	2017	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**	**2013**	**2012**	**2011**
Philosophy	**27.6**	27.6	32.3	30.2	31.2	31.8	22.3
Politics	**40.1**	40.6	41.1	41.2	39.1	40.9	44.0
Economics	**32.4**	31.8	26.5	28.6	29.7	27.3	33.7

b. Average mark and standard deviation for subjects in each branch:

	2017	**2016**	**2015**	**2014**
All Subjects (Avg)	**65.0**	65.4	65.2	65.3
All Subjects (St Dev)	**6.8**	6.1	6.1	6.1
Total	**1901**	1854		
Philosophy (Avg)	**65.1**	65.8	65.6	64.9
Philosophy (St Dev)	**5.0**	5.2	5.1	5.1
Total	**524**	512		
Politics (Avg)	**65.7**	65.8	65.5	65.8
Politics (St Dev)	**5.9**	5.0	5.3	5.1
Total	**761**	756		
Economics (Avg)	**64.1**	64.6	64.5	64.8
Economics (St Dev)	**8.8**	7.7	7.5	8.3
Total	**616**	586		

c. Classifications broken down by routes through PPE:

2017

Class	**Phil-Ec**	**Pol-Ec**	**Phil-Pol**	**Phil-Pol-Ec**
1st	12 25.5%	19 20.9%	22 26.2%	1 6.3%
2.1	29 61.7%	67 73.6%	60 71.4%	14 87.5%
2.2	6 12.8%	3 3.3%	2 2.4%	1 6.3%
3rd	0	2 2.2%	0	0
Total	47 19.7%	91 38.2%	84 35.3%	16 6.7%

2016

Class	**Phil-Ec**	**Pol-Ec**	**Phil-Pol**	**Phil-Pol-Ec**
1st	7 16.7%	15 16.7%	15 17.4%	1 7.1%
2.1	31	69	67	12

	73.8%	76.7%	77.9%	85.7%
2.2	4 9.5%	6 6.7%	4 4.7%	1 7.1%
Total	42 18.1%	90 38.8%	86 37.1%	14 6.0%

6. Applications for Consideration of Factors Affecting Performance
See Part B: Chair's Comments, section 4.

7. Supervised Dissertation and Thesis Titles

Supervised Dissertations in Politics: (9)

- Age matters: regime duration and barriers to electoral reform
- Do autocracies or autocrats go to war? How is the effect of audience costs on autocratic conflict behaviour conditional on leadership experience?
- Do gender quotas have a multiplier effect on female representation in the long run? Evidence from Taiwan
- Does the relationship between agrarian inequality and the outbreak of civil war change with a climate shock?
- How role do economic grievances affect support for UKIP?
- Identity clash? Understanding drivers of the relative strength of British vs. Muslim identity
- Realising the benefits of trade liberalisation: veto players and trade complementary policy (reform)
- Take back control or stronger together? A quantitative analysis of the EU referendum campaigns' effectiveness in changing public opinion and vote choice
- The Muslim-majority democracy gap: A question of transition or survival?

(The supervised dissertation submitted in FHS History & Politics was:

- *Pinkwashing the LGBT movement: the emancipatory limits of identity politics)*

Theses in Philosophy (12)

- Colonialism and domination: what's wrong with colonialism
- Could a digital computing system be conscious?
- Darwinian defeat: what bearing do evolutionary debunking arguments have on non-naturalist moral realism?
- Does merely being human matter? Wittgenstein on animal ethics
- Is experience required for virtue?
- Life and natality in Hannah Arendt
- Should a feminist be utilitarian? The difference justification and practice make in moral philosophy
- Should Marxists pursue moral theory?
- The agent's belief and the intending/merely foreseeing distinction: a defence of the doctrine of double effect
- The moral arena: examining the explanatory resources of naturalism and theism
- The procreation asymmetry reconsidered
- The telic desire theory of the good
- What is Spinoza's theory of truth?

Theses in Politics (21):

- "A fiction, if not a farce": how authentic was the reunion in the Liberal party between 1923 and 1924?
- "Marx is my main man": a critique of intersectionality through Selma James' materialism
- A critical evaluation of care ethics: analysing caring labour through the politics of domination
- Ambivalent universality: conceptualisations of the universal and their theoretical and strategic implications for emancipatory politics.
- Do voters in the United States punish incumbents for opportunistic electoral economic manipulation?
- Exploiting extremism: Islam and political economy in Karimov's Uzbekistan
- Exploring the effects of religious versus ethnic divisions on the political agenda in Sub-Saharan Africa
- How can a conservative account for political obligation?
- How can divergent trajectories of state capacity in Sub-Saharan Africa since the 'third wave of democratisation' be explained?
- How important a role did the Irish language and language revival movement play in the development of the Irish state from the turn of the 20th century until the establishment of the Republic in 1948?
- In defence of philosopher-kings: a Platonic critique of modern democracy
- Mothers and motherlands: an analysis of familial duties and their bearing on nationalism
- New radical right parties in East-Central Europe: the end of Eastern European exceptionalism
- Patterns of repression and schism in Somalia's Islamist Movement: 2006-2010
- Populist, radical, and reactionary: the many definitions of Khomeini's political Islam, and their role in revolutionary Iran 1979-81
- Setting the agenda: variation in the vote of confidence procedure and cabinet survival in Europe
- The Irish question and colonialism in Marx and Engels
- The revolution is not a dinner party: towards a Marxist theory of non-human animals
- The theory and practice of media impartiality
- To what extent does electoral commission independence shape the prospects for democratic consolidation: the case of Kenya
- What sources of legitimacy matter for successful civil war mediation?

(The 11 Politics theses submitted in FHS History & Politics were:

- *"Not Traditions - Precedents!" A study of the Scottish nationalism of the SNP 79 Group.*
- *Disunited Kingdom? An investigation into whether the strength of separatist movements in the UK rely on their viability as independent states*
- *Dominating politics as a 'catch-all' party: a case study of the People's Action Party in Singapore*
- *Implications of a libertarian approach to intellectual property rights*
- *Middle powers in the twenty years' crisis*
- *Negotiating the sub-state: the institutionalization of Hezbollah 1989-92*
- *Partisan signals and EU attitudes: the case of the European Constitutional Treaty (ECT) Referenda*
- *The art of hegemony: soft power in hegemonic and imperial systems*
- *The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank; implications for the structure, character and future of the international order*
- *The chronopolitics of targeted killing: exposing temporalities in the Obama administration's counterinsurgency discourse*
- *The right to 'rough' sleep in the liberal state)*

Theses in Economics (0)

PART B: Chair's Comments

1. Personnel
(a) Internal Examiners

There were 11 internal examiners.

Philosophy	Frank Arntzenius (Convenor), Hilary Greaves, Jeff McMahan
Politics	Patricia Thornton (Convenor), Nancy Bermeo, Michael Hart, Carlotta Minnella, Stuart White
Economics	Godfrey Keller (Chair), Ferdinand Rauch (Convenor), Simon Cowan

(b) External Examiners

Philosophy	Mike Otsuka (London School of Economics)
Politics	Stephen Hopgood (School of Oriental and African Studies)
Economics	Gianni de Fraja (University of Nottingham)

The External Examiners reviewed and commented on draft question papers at the paper-setting stage; they read a selection of scripts from different classes; they attended the First Examiners' Meeting on the afternoon of Tuesday 4 July 2017 and the Final Examiners' Meeting on Thursday 6 July 2017.

2. Marking Conventions
The scale of marks used and the classification conventions were the same as in the previous year. A number of changes were made to the Examination Conventions in order to conform to the University standard template.

- Links to rubrics for each paper were introduced.
- For papers taken outside the PPE Departments, links to the relevant marking criteria were introduced. For joint papers, it was clarified which of the three PPE subjects' marking criteria would be applied.
- For papers taken outside the PPE Department, it was clarified where procedures in other Departments' conventions would be applied.
- Template text on scaling was introduced.
- A rule for overweight scripts was introduced.
- A rule for rubric breach scripts was introduced.

3. Problems with Exam Papers
For three papers, minor corrections were made just before or during the exam:

i. 227 / A12743W1: Politics in China
In question 5, 'ruled of law' was corrected to 'rule of law'.

ii. 216 / A12733W1: Political Thought: Bentham to Weber
On the front cover, the rubric was clarified (clarification in italics): "Candidates are required to show knowledge of THREE of the set authors. *Main set authors, those referred to in Questions 1-8.*" Next to the questions, a clarification of 'prescribed authors' was added: "*any 19th or 20th century author who appears in the reading list*".

iii. 215 / A12732W1: Political Thought: Plato to Rousseau
In question 10, 'studies' was corrected to 'studied'.

4. General Issues

Philosophy has had a *de facto* Subject Board[1] for a number of years. This year, for the first time, Economics had a Subject Board (officially for Econ & Mgmt, unofficially for PPE & other joint FHS's involving Economics). Politics has yet to establish a Subject Board for examining, and so the PPE board of examiners serves as a sort of hybrid Classification Board with Subject Board elements. The examiners (including the Politics external) encouraged Politics to adopt a Subject Board for FHS's, if not in AY17-18, then by AY18-19.

i. Complaints & Factors Affecting Performance (FAPS)

- It is the responsibility of the **Subject Board** to "deal with complaints about the setting of individual question papers, and provide a report on this to the Classification Board (and any other examination boards whose candidates took this paper)."
- It is the responsibility of the **Classification Board** to "consider factors affecting performance, and medical or other special circumstances in relation to individual candidates."

Unfortunately, those in the Proctors' Office seem unaware of this distinction. This meant that problems that should have been dealt with by the chairs of the Subject Boards (or the exam convenor in the case of Politics) all came to the Classification Board.

ii. FAPS

There were over 40 submissions for 'Factors Affecting Performance' (up from 25 last year). In three cases, these applications resulted in a change to the candidate's classification; in a few other cases, marks were minimally adjusted without affecting any candidate's classification.

- Factors that were acute, unforeseen & unforeseeable were more likely to be given strong consideration; examples include death of a close college friend the evening before an exam, being hospitalised with an infection during the exam period, breaking the arm you write with shortly before the start of the exams. Examples that don't stand up very well include itchy arms and back, chronic toothache, breaking up with boyfriend/girlfriend over Easter.

iii. Requests for marks to be checked

The Junior Proctor uses the following criterion for granting a request for a candidate's marks for a particular paper to be checked: "the mark for this paper is more than 10 points adrift of the average for the candidate's other papers in this exam". There were 238 PPE candidates, and in 67 cases the candidate's lowest met that criterion – **that is over 25% of the candidates, so is not particularly uncommon**. I suggest the Proctor considers using a more apt criterion.

iv. Data Protection Act

The amount of effort used in servicing 'subject access requests' under the DPA is becoming unmanageable. As of 30 September, there have been 32 such requests since results were released in July. Some candidates want very detailed information (marks question-by-question for both initial markers, e-mails, minutes of meetings, etc), others want statistical analysis of their performance (e.g. ranks & percentiles for each paper both based on their subject cohort – e.g. Economics – and on their FHS – PPE). It is unclear to me how to

[1] A Subject Board is responsible for setting and marking the papers in its own subject (e.g. Economics). When marking is complete, it reports the marks to the appropriate Classification Boards for the Final Honour Schools (e.g. Economics and Management, PPE, History and Economics).

manage this increasing burden. One possibility is (a) to delete as much detail as possible (marks question-by-question, comments, etc) as soon as the Classification Board has signed off, although this would compromise our ability to respond to 'requests for marks to be checked'; and (b) to fully anonymise the remaining data (agreed marks and initial marks) and make the agreed marks available to all candidates so that they can make statistical calculations. Guidance from the Proctors on, for example, what level of detail to retain would be welcome.

v. History & Politics

It seems that the reason for including some information on H&P candidates here is that it is not included in the H&P exam board report. This needs to be rectified as from AY17-18.

vi. Answer booklet … the front page needs redesigning.

- First, no-one (candidates, examiners/assessors, admin support staff) knows what to write in the box labelled "Examination". (We are informed by UAS Exam Arrangements that it's something like 'FHS PPE' or 'MSc in Theology' or 'Prelims in Engineering' – in which case why are candidates not given an example in the box.)
- Many examiners/assessors feel it would be very helpful to have a box to be filled in on the front page of the first booklet with the numbers of the questions attempted in the order that they are in the answer booklet(s). (On subsequent booklets, they could enter simply write the numbers of the questions in that particular booklet.) This would particularly help the majority of markers who mark, say, all attempts at Q4 then all attempts at Q6, and so on.
- Also, a box (front page of first booklet) in which to write the total number of answer books used.
- One reason for these latter two boxes is that an increasing number of exams have sections that are marked by different pairs of people – X + co-marker will mark section A, Y + co-marker will mark section B; in these cases one candidate's booklets are distributed accordingly and someone later has to reassemble the set. As things stand, there is no easy way to check that they've all been put back together. (Further, it would facilitate one aspect of responding to requests for marks to be checked.)

A copy of the front page of the first booklet that LSE uses is attached; Oxford might like to consider using some of the good elements of their design.

vii. Precedents

In a paper in which the rubric instructed candidates to 'show knowledge of A and B', two candidates failed to do so. The examiners agreed that an appropriate penalty was to reduce the mark for the paper proportionately, in this case by 1/6, i.e. effectively ignoring one half of one of the 3 answers the candidates had to write.

viii. Range of marks

Markers/assessors need yet more encouragement (and instruction) to use a wider range of marks. Economics had made progress on this over the last few years; Politics had made an effort but they acknowledged that their marks were still notably compressed, as were the Philosophy marks. Excluding papers were the take-up was small (4 candidates or fewer), the average standard deviation of marks in Economics was 6.7, Politics 5.7, and Philosophy 4.3.

[INSERT LSE SCRIPT EXAMPLE]

PART C: Internal Examiners' Comments

a. Philosophy
See separate report covering all Philosophy Honour Schools.

b. Economics
See separate report covering all Economics Honour Schools.

c. Politics
TOP PERFORMANCES & PRIZES

Gibbs Prizes for the best Politics written papers in the Final Honour Schools of PPE and History and Politics:

1st – Eleanor Shearer, Balliol (HP)
2nd – Cara Pacitti, University (HP)

Proxime Accessit:

Georgina Evans, St Anne's (PPE)
Leo McGrath, Lady Margaret Hall (HP)

Gibbs Prize for the best Politics thesis or supervised dissertation in the Final Honour Schools of PPE and History and Politics:

Georgina Evans, St Anne's (PPE)
Proxime Accessit: Stefan Marjanovic, Merton (PPE)

FHS PPE & MHP POLITICS EXAMINERS' REPORTS 2017

201 Comparative Government

There were 53 candidates (47 PPE, 6 HP).

In general terms, the script seemed to be quite straightforward. No questions were reported during the exam and answers rarely appeared to miss the point or fail to address the question posed in the exam. The average grade across all scripts was 65.51, the standard deviation 5.31. There has been an increase in the spread of the grades.

As it typically happens, some questions were clearly more popular than others. This was mainly the case for questions 2—democratisation—and 5—PR and redistribution. Question 8—on federalism—was also very popular, whereas some questions appeared much less so. This applies to questions 9 (constitutions), 11 (interest groups) and 12 (democratic outcomes). Two out of three of these questions were new and thus it is likely that it has not yet featured in many tutorial series. More problematic is the lack of answers on the question about interest groups.

Question 1: The complete answer would need go beyond the standard war-makes-state approach, by incorporating also insights about the way state form national identities and bring in historical perspectives about the emergence of modern states and they both the causes and products of 19th and early 20th century nationalism. Discussion about more recent state building examples in Asia,

Africa and in post-conflict societies, especially after the partition of the Soviet Union and the post-communist world in general, would enrich the depth of the answer.

Question 2: The classic debate here between structural explanations, such as economic prosperity, inequality, availability of natural resources versus a more versatile economy that gives rise to a middle class that can credibly threat to move should be one part of the answer. All the debate between Stokes, Przewroski, Boix and Acemoglu et al. on the one hand and the attempts to bring these insights together, looking at over-time changes and heterogeneity, like Geddes, on the other. This part should then be complemented by agentic approaches, which try to look more at how elites took decisions under conditions of uncertainty that had implications about democratisation in the future. Work by Giovanni, Ziblatt and other are particularly helpful here.

Question 3: The complete answer starts with competitive authoritarianism, discusses the role of international links and strong party organization (the distinction between party-driven regimes versus top-down military regimes) but also goes beyond these insights to discuss examples of dictatorships with and without elections. Work by Svolik and others is very important in this respect.

Question 4: Here it is important to answer the question. Many scripts discussed the two strands of the literature quite well but failed to combine them together, properly answering the question. This was the main demarcation line between good and excellent answers.

Question 5: Here we need to start with the empirical pattern, provide some examples or studies demonstrating that PR redistributes more and then move to the reasons this is the case: Varieties of capitalism; Rodden/Tabbellini and Boix provide three different explanations. Two of them are exogenous and only one is endogenous (Boix). Then we need to delve into the origins of PR, with historical examples, to unpack the processes, discussing the coming of the labour movement and its link with PR. Successful answers did this more explicitly than others.

Question 6: This was a straightforward answer; most answers were quite complete, although it was difficult to excel and distinguish between them. Best scripts combined examples with systematic evidence and discussed some theoretical models with some precision.

Question 7: This question was not as popular as I would expect, but I think this is also due to the fact that clientilism is a new topic. Although here we had a very clear question and most scripts did try to answer the question, they missed insights from the clientelism literature that would help them provide more convincing explanations as to how clientilism works given the ballot is secret.

Question 8: This is a very straightforward question. There was no need to discuss the economic consequences of federalism as the question explicitly wants students to look at non-economic implications. I missed examples here which are important in this literature, as for example in Bermeo and others. But the quality of answers was on average quite high in this question.

Question 9: Too few observations

Question 10: This was another standard question; it did require some definition and understanding of what we mean by efficiency in this context. Some answers drew on the role of the committees which was an interesting take, but not essential for a very good answer. Some answers limited their

focus on the distinction between parliamentary and presidential systems. This was not enough for a high mark in this answer.

Question 11: Too few observations

Question 12: Too few observations

201 Comparative Government (Old Rubric)

5 candidates (4 PPE; 1 HP)

In general, this was also a straightforward paper. Some confusion in the answers appeared with respect to question 1, where the link between ideological spread and number of parties was not made sufficiently clear. The usual suspects were far more popular than the rest of questions: federalism, party systems and the judiciary, although of course numbers are small. One could notice lack of systematic discussion of methodological issues arising in the literature for some of these topics, perhaps an indication of how Q-Step has helped students to read published work in a more critical fashion.

202 British Government and Politics since 1900

There were 88 candidates; 16 in History and Politics, and 72 in PPE. This represents a continued increase in the numbers taking the paper. The pattern of answers between MHP and PPE was virtually identical.

1. **In what ways was New Liberalism liberal?** (20 answers)

   Most essays concluded that it was liberal – some also argued that it was Liberal. Good answers explained neatly what they understood as New Liberalism and why it had evolved. A few struggled because they insisted that Liberalism was what existed in the nineteenth century and therefore a government presiding over an expanded state and higher taxation was advanced but it could not be liberal. Some (rightly) wrote that New Liberalism was not only to be equated with Liberals in government and went on to draw distinctions between the theorists and social observers and their permutation of other political parties. There were however several clear critiques of the Liberals in office linked with arguments that the war interrupted a set of ideas which was still evolving and which, in the view of a few, continued after 1918 in spite of Liberal decline. A good set of answers.

2. **What did the Labour Party stand for before 1918?** (25 answers)

   Candidates lent different weight to different aspects – trade union rights; socialism; working class representation, or, in the view of at least two 'not very much at all'. Essays usually demonstrated sound knowledge of developments, although some stopped abruptly in 1914 leaving the reader guessing about the significance of the war. Most, however, knew about the wartime expansion of trade unionism, Labour's divisions and the coming of Labour's new constitution and mass enfranchisement. There were a few skilful essays which detailed Labour's position within the pre-1918 political system and how this justified ideological ambiguity and tactical compromise alongside emerging union solidarity.

3. **Did the First World War inaugurate or merely accelerate political change?** (18 answers)

   A few very good answers, but in several cases candidates used the question as a proxy for questions they wished had been set – notably the decline of the Liberals or Ireland. Each is worthy of mention, but not a whole answer when the question was clearly broader. Most answers plumped for 'accelerate'', but those which chose 'inaugurate' looked at (amongst other things) the expanded role and functioning of the state, the consequences of the country's indebtedness for inter-war politics, how mass democracy worked after 1918 – not merely the fact that it happened. A surprising number made no mention of the Conservatives at all.

4. **Who opposed women's suffrage and why?**(5 answers)
   Well informed and usually thoughtful essays, especially those addressing issues such as property and the view of the vote as a 'trust', education, and how the behaviour of more radical groups affected opinion.

5. **Should inter-war Communism and Fascism be analysed together?** (4 answers)

   Candidates thought that they should (or at least could) be analysed together. The standard of the few answers was very high.

6. **EITHER: Why was appeasement accepted so readily in domestic politics in the 1930s?** (No answers).

   OR: Why was decolonisation accepted so readily in domestic politics after 1945? (7 answers)

   An interesting variety of approaches. Most mentioned a lack of interest in empire and domestic ignorance of it, combined with the pressing needs of domestic legislation. Some stressed the 'moral' issues of the out-datedness of imperialism, while a couple of essays were economics-based and looked at Britain's changing trade patterns in the 1950s (which also allowed reference to Europe). The role of the Conservative governments in promoting decolonisation was also examined, concluding that old fashioned imperialists were left with nowhere to go.

7. **Given its legislative achievements, why did the Attlee government fail to maintain its majority of 1945?** (40 answers)

   Candidates knew a great deal about the period and the question differentiated those whose knowledge was flexible and those who were more brittle and stuck rather too closely to what the government did with a perfunctory sentence or two describing its end. Some answers argued that 1945 was an exceptional result brought about by circumstances which could not be repeated. Labour's performances in 1950 and 1951 were therefore creditable. Many essays stressed the more 'mechanical' aspects of Labour's problems by 1951 –

redistribution of seats, crash of the Liberals and the vagaries of the electoral system. A smaller number explored the more difficult problems surrounding Labour's own performance in office and whether the party had reached an ideological impasse by 1951.

8. **How successful have governments been since the 1950s in addressing problems arising from immigration?** (2 answers)

   Too small a number of answers on which to comment.

9. **Which tells us more about the behaviour of Labour governments of the 1960s and 1970s: social or economic policies?** (16 answers)

   The standard was a little disappointing. Most candidates knew about social reforms, although not about the opposition they encountered. Arguments based on economics were often thin on analysis and sometimes based on rudimentary comments concerning devaluation, trade unions and the IMF crisis. A few essays considered what economic problems the governments faced and why they responded as they did. This allowed more subtle interpretations of, for example, pay and prices policies, trade union co-operation as well as antagonism, and why attempts to maintain 'confidence' in the currency were considered important. A few interesting essays explored the behaviour of the governments as part of an evolving (or stagnant) social democracy, but too often more basic answers simply assumed that small majorities inhibited Labour whilst a large majority did not.

10. **Was the power of the state reduced between 1979 and 1997?** (30 answers)
    The question allowed several different interpretations and many answers were thoughtful and perceptive. Perhaps because it was not a straightforward 'Conservative' question, the 'power of the state' provoked interpretations ranging from the neo-liberal to the Marxisant – two approaches which, from different directions, agreed in deploring the continuing power of the state. More pragmatic answers usually contrasted economics (reduction in state power) with social affairs (increase in state intervention). A few answers considered whether the state gave itself the potential to grow even if it did not fully utilise it – relations with local government and education policy were often used examples. Some commented that the change in government in 1997 made little difference to this. The standard of argument of the best answers was very high.

11. **Is 'New Labour' better understood as an electoral project or an ideological project?** (50 answers)

    The most answered question. Essays tended towards the 'ideological' interpretation with a significant minority favouring the 'electoral'. A smaller number argued, often cogently, that the two were indivisible. More than in other questions, there was a tendency towards unsubstantiated overstatement, which inhibited good arguments. That Labour worked to remain in power is undisputed, but its motives for doing so might have been the implementation of policy (whether ultimately coherent or not) rather than simply low cunning. More thoughtful approaches considered what sort of ideology Labour might have

stimulated, why 'ethical socialism' was abandoned, as some thought, and how important a reformed Labour party was in driving a changed relationship between private and public sectors. Some 'electoral project' answers drew on sociological concepts to contrast (favourably) a Labour party which took advantage of societal change with (unfavourably) a Conservative party which did not. A surprisingly large number of answers ignored 2007-10, therefore making no reference to the financial crisis and its consequences.

12. **'Great change and real progress lie ahead'. [The Coalition: Our Plan for Government, 2010]. Had this been achieved by 2015?** (2 answers)
Whether it had been achieved or not, it certainly did not interest students in this examination.

The standard of the scripts was high – at the top end, excellent. Those (few) which were very weak were submitted by candidates who would have been well advised to attend the lectures.

203 Theory of Politics

149 candidates (93 Politics-PPE; 37 Philosophy-PPE; 19 HP)

Overall candidates showed a good knowledge and understanding of political concepts. Answers were highly concentrated on particular questions, however, with some important topics receiving little or no attention. Also, a theme merging from the comments on specific questions below is that candidates were sometimes too narrow in their approaches to certain concepts or arguments.

1. If the state did not exist, would we have a moral obligation to invent it?

This was quite a popular question. Better answers were able to relate ideas and arguments from the literature on political obligation in a focused way to the specific question.

2. Can there be liberty outside the rule of law?

This question was less popular than questions on liberty have tended to be in recent years. This is somewhat surprising since the relationship of law to liberty connects with some central debates such as the debate between proponents of negative and positive liberty and, in particular, between liberty as 'non-interference' and liberty as 'non-domination'. Those who answered the question made the connections but that relatively few attempted it suggests that many candidates may not have seen them.

3. Do representative legislatures express or compromise the ideal of democracy?

This was a popular question which was generally well answered. Some of the better answers noted that 'representation' can take the form of representation by lot (sortition) not only representation by election.

4. 'The equality that matters fundamentally is our equality as citizens.' Discuss.

This was a popular question. Better answers were able to draw on the literature on relational (and luck) egalitarianism in a selective way, answering the question while avoiding an unfocused

literature review. Some answers also considered whether the category of 'citizen' might itself be criticisable on relational egalitarian grounds.

5. Do we have persuasive reasons to regard the distribution of income and wealth produced by market forces as just?

This was a popular question. Many answers focused on Nozick's entitlement theory and the quality of these answers depended on the depth of understanding of this theory. However, many answers did not consider other putative justifications for market-based distribution such as provided by desert theory or arguments from the incentive effects of allowing inequality in market-derived incomes.

6. What distinguishes a 'right' from some other value or claim that is important but not a 'right'?

There were too few answers to comment on.

7. Has the term 'liberalism' become too elastic to tell us very much about someone's political beliefs?

There were not many answers to this question. Answers showed reasonable knowledge and understanding of liberalism but sometimes presented somewhat narrow constructions of liberalism, e.g., focusing only on Rawlsian/post-Rawlsian formulations.

8. How, if at all, does feminism affect our understanding of what politics is?

This was a popular question. Answers tended to show good or very good knowledge and understanding of how feminist thought reconceives the site of politics. Perhaps answers could have given more attention to whether/how feminist thought might also have implications for the doing of politics.

9. Is socialism's major flaw that it puts too much faith in our capacity to plan the good society?

There were too few answers to comment on.

10. EITHER: Must conservatives be nationalists?

There were some thoughtful answers, but answers tended to rely too much on accounts of conservatism in the secondary literature and did not show enough direct knowledge of primary texts. More knowledge and understanding of primary texts may have enabled candidates to direct their answers more confidently to the idea of 'nationalists'.

10. OR: Should we be 'citizens of the world'?

This was a popular question. Most answers connected the question to the literatures on global justice and/or global democracy and showed a good or very good knowledge and understanding of this literature in ways that addressed the question. Answers sometimes also included thoughtful reflection on the notion of the 'citizen'.

11. 'Power is at its most effective when it is hardest to observe.' Discuss.

There were not many answers but these tended to be well-informed and focused on the specific question.

12. Is utopianism necessarily undesirable in a political theory?

Although not a popular question there were some original and outstanding answers.

204 Modern British Government and Politics

19 candidates (18 PPE; 1 HP)

1. 'Since we have no good way of measuring the power of backbench MPs, nothing reliable can be said about whether it has risen or fallen in recent years.' Discuss. (7 answers)

The best answers to this question engaged with the question of measurement, while weaker answers simply treated it as another way of asking whether backbench power had risen or fallen. There was good knowledge of what had been done by way of procedural and institutional reform, but weaker answers simply reported these reforms without saying what their effects had been, or why it might be hard to judge.

2. Has reform of the House of Lords failed? If so, why? (11 answers)

This was a popular question. Better answers introduced criteria for success and failure and offered more sophisticated expositions of the factors that best explain why reform has stalled. Weaker answers tended to 'over-explain' in ways that made it mysterious why reform had even been attempted; or became distracted by normative debates about the desirability of reform; or failed to cite evidence of the alleged failure (or success).

3. 'Each new Prime Minister promises to restore cabinet government, but prime ministerial government is how the core executive works.' Is this true? (4 answers)

The stronger answers to this question were familiar with models of executive power and the evidence of how the UK executive operates. Some answers confined themselves to considering only the models named in the question, which was not required. Weaker answers took a crude view of what the models claimed or implied. In one or two cases, they were also out of date.

4. Does the UK still have a unified civil service? (3 answers)

The better answers defined 'unified' and showed a good knowledge of recent changes to the civil service. They also considered why the civil service was changing, and the political and bureaucratic forces which were shaping the changes.

5. What effects has austerity had on the way that the UK government operates?

There were no answers to this question.

6. 'The UK now has a quasi-federal system in all its parts except England.' Do you agree? (6 answers)

Again, the stronger answers established good definitions and tests of the key term in the question ('quasi-federal'), while weaker answers were broad surveys of the 'state and prospects of devolution'.

The alleged English exception was not very often given attention, and some answers were almost entirely focused on Scotland. This was an opportunity to make good use of the set documents, which the better answers did.

7. Why did Scottish voters reject independence in 2014?

There were no answers to this question.

8. 'Competence in government wins general elections in the UK, and incompetence in government loses them.' Do you agree? (10 answers)

The better answers to this question – of which there were many – recognized the allusion to valence models of voting behaviour and offered well-informed accounts of their plausibility. The small number of weaker answers were simply under-informed in this respect, and offered superficial narrative accounts of recent elections.

9. Does the UK now have a multi-party system? (3 answers)

The best answers deployed measures of the numbers of significant parties, were aware of the problems of measurement, and of the multiple levels of the party system. They also explained the forces that were shaping the party system. This question was answered on 30 May, nine days before the 2017 General Election. Candidates were not faulted for failing to foresee the result, but speculation was unwise.

10. Are UK political parties themselves to blame for the generally declining rates of party membership over the last forty years? (8 answers)

Most candidates who attempted this question had a good knowledge of trends in the party membership data and the main theories that attempt to explain it. The question of whether the parties were at fault was not always very directly tackled, and where it was, candidates tended to forget the theories and simply blame the parties for lack of effort. The Corbyn exception was intelligently analysed by those who mentioned it.

11. Does the UK media distort the policy-making process? (3 answers)

A good answer to this question would have defined and explained 'distortion'. Weaker answers focused on whether the media (neither defined nor differentiated) distorted politics in general rather than the policy-making process.

12. EITHER: What does the dispute over the power of the executive to initiate the UK's exit from the European Union tell us about the UK constitution? (2 answers)

There were very few answers to this question.

OR: What, if anything, is distinctive about those who voted for 'Brexit'?

There were no answers to this question.

205 Government and Politics of the United States

24 candidates (23 PPE; 1 HP)

There was a normal distribution of answers to this year's questions with only one (concerning the administrative presidency) receiving no responses at all. Questions regarding polarisation and American exceptionalism proved to be most popular.

Q3. Federalism and State Government: Most answers, and all the best, demonstrated a secure understanding of innovations by state governments. The complex state matrix of marijuana and assisted dying policies proved fertile ground for some highly analytical arguments.

Q4. Parties: Provoked mostly excellent answers with the highest average mark by some distance. The majority of these answers stood out for their original thought and meticulously constructed arguments.

Q6. Presidential power: The lowest average mark of any of the more frequently answered questions with a dearth of answers above the first class boundary. Many answers lacked the depth of empirical evidence with which to measure the independent variable suggested in the question – social movements – whilst still giving an account of presidential power. Carefully defining social movements, even if that meant doing so more broadly than the literature, would have helped in most cases.

Q7. Supreme Court: Some extremely good answers on the constraints faced by the court. The very best answers deployed fine-grained empirical evidence from the court's extensive jurisprudence. On the whole those answers at the other end of the distribution of marks made very little reference to case law.

Q8. Affirmative action: Well answered on the whole.

Q10. Electoral polarisation: Some of the best and worst marks of the paper were awarded for answers to this polarisation question. A few of the best answers cast a quizzical glance at the dichotomy. Many of those at the other end of the distribution merely outlined a version of polarisation without addressing the question on its own terms. The crucial term 'inter-party animus' received too little attention in many cases.

Q11. Exceptionalism: Commenting on the generic nature of many of the exceptionalism answers is something of an annual tradition for examiners in paper 205, but not one that shows any sign of dying out. Despite the exceptionally clear question posed only a handful of the best answers interrogated the comparative aspects of exceptionalism suggested by the question.

206 Politics in Europe

7 candidates (5 PPE; 2 HP)

There were seven scripts of which two were excellent, and the other five achieved a 2.1 standard.

The quality of individual answers was generally high, with the best answers demonstrating a very good understanding of the key theoretical arguments and using a broad range of empirical examples from states across Europe.

Out of the 13 questions (including one either-or question), nine questions attracted at least one answer, and four questions received no attempts. The detailed question breakdown is as follows:

Q	N
1	3
3	3
5	3
6	1
7	1
8a	1
8b	3
9	4
10	2

Specific notes on questions with a substantial number of answers:

9 This was a popular question. The best answers combined a very good understanding of theoretical arguments with an excellent ability to present and critically evaluate the results of quantitative and qualitative analyses.

207 Politics in Russia and the Former Soviet Union

The examination was taken by 9 PPE students and 1 HPol student.

Frequency of responses: low (up to 3), high (more than 3).

1) **Assess the impact of Mikhail Gorbachev's reforms on the political institutions of the Soviet state.** (Low)

   The better answers considered the impact of Gorbachev's reforms on both state and Communist Party institutions. They also provided details on individual reforms.

2) **Were the national uprisings of the late 1980s motivated by the instrumental concerns of political elites?** (High)

   The stronger answers engaged with instrumental and primordial conceptualisations of nationalism. They discussed important differences in the intensity of nationalist feeling across the Soviet Union and discussed how the factors shaping mobilisation varied over the course of perestroika.

3) **Are authoritarian failure and authoritarian success the only two outcomes for post-Soviet regimes?** (None)

4) **To what extent is presidentialism a source of institutional instability in post-Soviet politics?** (High)

The top answers distinguished between the formal and informal bases of instability and stability in presidential systems across the region. They engaged with the literatures on both the 'perils of presidentialism' and 'patronal politics'.

5) **What is 'political capitalism' and why does it thrive in non-Baltic post-Soviet economies?** (Low)

The better answers gave a clear definition of the concept of 'political capitalism' and identified the historical, structural and policy factors that have contributed to its dominance in post-Soviet economies.

6) **Why did some regimes in the former Soviet Union develop a dominant political party while others did not?** (Low)

Many answers to this question showed excellent comparative knowledge of where dominant parties had emerged. However, candidates were often less certain in their discussion of the causal factors that may account for this variation.

7) **'In competitive electoral authoritarian regimes rulers are insecure; in hegemonic electoral authoritarian regimes they are invincible.' (Schedler, 2002) Discuss.** (Low)

Good answers used the comparative literature on electoral authoritarianism to good effect to analyse under what conditions competitive and hegemonic authoritarian regimes are more or less vulnerable to electoral defeat.

8) **How has nationalism shaped the development of post-Soviet states?** (Low)

The better answers distinguished between majority and minority nationalism. They also showed good knowledge of the patterns of post-Soviet nationalism and the causes of nationalist mobilization.

9) **EITHER: By which mechanisms, if any, does resource wealth hinder democratisation in post-Soviet states?** (High)

Answers to this question generally showed good knowledge of the literature. Some of the weaker discussions were vague regarding the specific mechanisms by which resource wealth is expected to hinder democratization.

OR: **Are countries with nationalised oil resources particularly susceptible to the resource curse?** (None)

10) **Do the varying levels of corruption in post-Soviet states reflect differences in cultural predisposition?** (None)

11) **Did the colour revolutions stabilise or destabilise authoritarianism in the former Soviet Union?** (High)

This was a popular question. Some of the better answers considered the structural conditions which brought about the colour revolutions and the extent to which they have had enduring effects. In addition, strong answers evaluated the processes of learning and emulation among defecting elites and protesters as well as among authoritarian elites.

12) **How have the external relations of post-Soviet states and societies shaped their internal political developments?** (None)

208 Politics in Sub-Saharan Africa

In general, students answered the examinations well and demonstrated good knowledge and the ability to coherently structure arguments. Of the twenty-seven students (twenty-two PPE students and five History and Politics students) who took the exam, eight had 1st class performances; seventeen were at 2:1 level. This is overall very positive, and the number of excellent performances is noteworthy (four scripts above 73% were outstanding and showed an impressive intellectual originality). As is sometimes the case with the 208 exam, some students struggled to maintain consistency across all three essays: candidates toward the lower 2:1 end sometimes had a mark at or below the 2:2/2:1 borderline, while candidates who performed well overall nonetheless often had one mark below the 2:1/1st borderline. As noted last year, it is likely that the somewhat uneven performance of most candidates across the three essays is down to the complex and varied nature of the course, and the broad range of empirical material that students must grasp.

A very positive aspect of this year's exam is that all questions were again tackled by students. However, as usual, there was a high level of bunching around certain essay topics. The question on economic reform attracted the attention of students, if less than in previous years, and resulted in capable but sometimes predictable essay. The question on conflict also proved popular, if less so than in the previous year. The quality of these essays showed a marked improvement away from predictable "greed and grievance" analysis and it featured less commonly used and interesting case studies. The questions on religion, gender and ethnicity were consistently good. The best essays were those that somehow contested the literature, rather than those that embraced well-worn positions in the literature. Only a few students attempted the questions on African state effectiveness and social movements.

Some candidates still lost marks for failing to define key terms or to answer all parts of a question, but this was less of an issue than last year. Those candidates that did engage with key concepts and major comparative debates in the literature developed more thorough and insightful contributions and were rewarded accordingly. One of the most positive aspects of this year's paper is that students answered questions with reference to no less than thirty different Sub-Saharan African states (a number that has continued to increase in recent years) and showed a strong commitment to sustained comparison. The over-concentration on one case study, and its deployment across several essays, was a relatively rare occurrence. However, Kenya, Nigeria, and Zambia were still more frequently engaged with than other cases. The Francophone states remained underrepresented but there was a significant increase in references to them as well as knowledge of the relevant literature. The Horn of Africa, which in previous years was rarely addressed, featured much more prominently across a number of questions.

The candidates could still do a better job in two areas brought up last year. One is for candidates to provide a more nuanced scoping of their answer: how representative are the cases they draw on? How are the examples provided situated in time and space? How generalizable are the suggested conclusions? Second, candidates should make a an effort to tackle essays, especially those that lend themselves to predictable treatments, in a more deliberately original manner, both theoretically and in terms of engaging with a broader range of case-studies (this said, improvements in the essays on topics such as conflict and economic reform show that students are taking this advice to heed). Yet the overall level of empirical and theoretical sophistication was commendable and this is again an excellent set of scripts.

209 Politics in Latin America

This paper was taken by six PPE candidates and one HP candidate. While there were some excellent scripts this year, there was also a greater variance in terms of quality when compared with previous years. There was only one first-class honours from the PPE cohort, together with four upper seconds and one lower second. All the scripts had a reasonably good grasp of the comparative literature, although as tends to be the case, the weaker scripts struggled to adequately summarize some of the extant literature, let alone engage with the central theoretical ideas. Once again, the weaker scripts struggled to demonstrate empirical knowledge; they simply did not know enough about the actual politics of Latin America. Even for some of the stronger upper seconds, while theoretically very strong, their weakness remained a lack of in-depth empirical knowledge. Below is the distribution of answers, by question:

Question	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
N	0	6	2	2	0	2	4	4	1	0	0	0

There was distinct clustering once again this year in the spread of answers. Question 2, on democratisation, proved to be the most popular, followed closely by Questions 7, on Latin American party systems, and Question 8, on the left in Latin America. In the previous two years, questions concerning the left across the region had been the most popular. There were some excellent answers to Question 2 and the mean mark here was in the mid-sixties. Some questions, which traditionally have received a lot of attention, such as those on populism and executive-legislative relations, proved far less popular this year. Once again, a range of questions remained unanswered.

210 Politics in South Asia

9 candidates (9 PPE; 0 HP)

Out of the twelve questions that had been set in the exam, nine were attempted by the nine candidates. Questions, 2, 8, and 10 were not attempted. The most frequently-answered question was question 12 (“Why has the hierarchical society of India not broken under the impact of electoral mobilisation?”) with six candidates answering it, followed by question 4 (“How and why has the structure of the Indian political system changed since 1991?”). It is also worth noting that many more answers were India-related than in reference to Pakistan or Sri Lanka. Bangladesh was not been explored as a case study by any of the candidates. The final grades that were awarded ranged from 58 (High 2.2) to 78 (Mid 1st). The majority of four essays were in the upper second range, two

were in the lower second, two in the low first, and one in the mid first. Overall, the answers showed a solid empirical knowledge, however, the connect between general political theory and its concepts, and the case of South Asia could have been more pronounced in some of the answers. It is noteworthy that in question 12, the most frequently-attempted one, many answers focussed exclusively on caste, rather than on other variables, such as the economy or gender.

211 Politics in the Middle East

40 candidates (32 PPE; 8 HP)

Examiners remarked on the noticeable lucidity and clarity of candidates' answers which underpinned strong performances across the cohort. The average mark was 68 and no lower second class marks were awarded. Particularly successful answers drew on a range of empirical material to support argument claims i.e. two or more case studies.

One of the most popular questions attempted was the oil and gas remain the ultimate guarantors of stability in the Gulf - particularly successful answers addressed the explanatory problems of rentier theory in relation to competing claims made by democratization theory.

The question on gender also produced several well-argued responses. Successful answers addressed and accounted for the question's assumption that masculine politics are the dominant form of gender politics in the Middle East. Good answers linked to the role of tribes in society and the salience of paternalism in business and public life.

Very few candidates attempted the question on comparing and contrasting Ottoman rule in the Middle East with Britain or France colonialism. Yet, the highest mark given was awarded to an answer to this question. The question on whether 'terrorism' is a useful term of analysis was similarly unpopular.

212 International Relations in the Era of Two World Wars

10 candidates (8 PPE; 2 HP)

10 candidates attempted this paper, of whom two were from the Joint School in History and Politics. Although this is a slightly smaller number than in previous years, the overall quality of the scripts was very high. Three candidates achieved First Class marks (70+) on the paper, and the rest were spread across the range of Upper Second Class marks.

The distribution of answers was as follows:

Q.	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**	**12**
Answers	3	5	0	3	4	1	6	4	1	0	1	2

The questions that attracted no answers (Nos. 3 & 10 on the paper) were on the international consequences of the Russian Revolution, and international political economy. This was somewhat

surprising as these topics, especially the former, have been popular in the past. I will comment on the seven questions that attracted more than two answers.

1. Why did Britain align with France against Germany before and during WW1?

Answers were very strong on Anglo-German rivalry, but could have gone into more depth on British relations with France.

2. Did Woodrow Wilson help or hinder the post-WW1 peace settlement in Europe?

This was one of the more popular questions on the paper, but attracted few really outstanding answers. Many struggled to get beyond some rather basic, textbook material. The best answers were very solid indeed in terms of their grasp of the Paris Peace Conference and wider issues surrounding the settlement.

4. Did the Mandates system work in the Middle East?

Answers to this question covered an unusually wide range of material, and were generally very strong on describing the operation of the Mandates system across the region, but often struggled to come to coherent evaluations of it.

5. Were the Locarno treaties an improvement on the Treaty of Versailles?

With one exception, the answers to this question were very strong indeed, developing very interesting appreciations of what might be involved in describing Locarno as an 'improvement'.

7. Does the League of Nations show that collective security does not work?

A rather mixed selection of answers in terms of quality. Weak answers failed to tackle the question and just concentrated on standard accounts of the League's activities. There were a couple of superb answers, though, which combined astute theoretical judgement with an exceptional range of empirical knowledge.

8. Was US foreign policy from 1921 to 1941 driven by economic interests?

One answer to this was excellent, with a formidable in depth knowledge of different aspects of US policy; alas, the others tended to focus on rather isolated moments of policy-making, and often failed to consider alternatives to the economic drivers suggested by the question.

213 International Relations in the Era of the Cold War

33 candidates (30 PPE; 3 HP)

The number of candidates remained strong for an options paper. No issues arose in the exam, the standard of papers was relatively high and consistent with previous years.

1. **'In a bipolar world, each of the two great powers is bound to focus its fears on the other, to distrust its motives, and to impute offensive intentions to defensive measures.' Does this explain the onset of the Cold War?**

Unsurprisingly a popular answer, and the standard was broadly good. Most candidates linked the statement in the question to structural realist explanations of the Cold War, and engaged with this as well as a range of other perspectives. Not untypically, middling answers struggled to go beyond rather vague 'many different factors matter to different extents' style conclusions – better answers offered more precise and theoretically informed assessments. Knowledge of evidence and key events was solid, and very strong in a few instances, but weaker answers typically failed to mention more than a few of the most obvious crises of the period.

2. **To what extent was US foreign policy 1953-1968 a consistent application of the strategy of containment?**
   A popular question with some strong and detailed essays, but weaker answers lacked deep engagement with different potential interpretations of containment and its specific implications for foreign policy action; many candidates would have benefitted from specifying more clearly what sorts of behaviour (or rationales for behaviour?) would and would not have been 'consistent'. A couple of answers displayed quite esoteric conceptions of what containment implied. Knowledge of the events of the period was somewhat varying, though most candidates were capable of assessing the fundamental continuities and differences between the presidencies of Eisenhower, Kennedy and Johnson.

3. **Was détente simply a consequence of 'mutually assured destruction'?**
   A popular question that generated a number of strong essays – several students showed cogent understandings of the ways in which mutually assured destruction may have enabled détente policies, and a number appropriately drew specific links with the USSR's pursuit and eventual attainment of nuclear parity. Almost all students wanted to conclude that détente was not, however 'simply a consequence' of MAD – answers varied in how successfully they brought in other key explanatory factors, and some expectedly descended into simply listing possible causes without much analysis or empirical detail.

4. **Why did the Cold War not end sooner?**
   A popular answer with a number of first class answers – the best drew out key causes of the end of the Cold War, supported these with evidence and examples, and argued that causes needed to overlap in a particular combination to allow the Cold War to end, something which did not happen until late in the Gorbachev administration. Several answers appropriately considered the interaction between structure and agency in bringing about the end of the Cold War, and/or linked the question to deeper theoretical analysis of what the Cold War was really sustained by. A number of weaker answers, however, lacked the necessary empirical evidence and detailed knowledge of events to really convince.

5. **How important was Marxist-Leninist ideology to the foreign policy of China, 1949-1991?**
   A few broadly competent answers, but these tended to be torn between those which either equivocated heavily on the importance of Marxist-Leninism ('it mattered somewhat'), or which used very crude tests for when ideology might matter. The strongest answers considered how Marxist-Leninism interacted with other important ideational and material interests in Chinese policy-making, such as nationalism, the need for economic development, and both domestic and geopolitical insecurities.

6. **Was the Cold War critical to the success of the Japanese-American alliance, 1952-1991?**
   Relatively few answers, but those which were offered showed good understanding of the key periods and aspects of Japanese foreign policy and the broad freedoms and constraints created by the US alliance in a Cold War context. Answers could have focused more specifically (and critically) on the success of that alliance, and done more to consider counterfactuals where Cold War pressures were weaker.

7. **Do liberal accounts of international relations best explain the foreign policies of France and West Germany in the Cold War?**
   Relatively few answers which, with one or two exceptions, often struggled to link the strong importance of NATO, integrationist policies, Western European development and reaching out to the USSR under De Gaulle/Brandt with liberal analysis of the possibility of cooperation under anarchy. Strong answers did often considered the significance of 'non-liberal' factors such as the power of US influence and alliance, or deviations from liberalism (and whether they were deviations) such as France's relatively independent line under De Gaulle. As in previous years, overlap between this topic and the Q8 topic below raises some questions as to whether they might not be more productively combined in future.

8. **Was European integration made possible because of Western European states' alliances with the United States?**
   Relatively few answers, though stronger ones showed some sophistication in appreciating the role of the US as a security guarantor and in post-War economic reconstruction in Europe, and detailed empirical knowledge of key steps in the development of the European project.

9. **Did decolonisation escalate the Cold War?**
   Too few takers to infer much.

10. **Was Eastern Europe an asset or a burden to the USSR, 1945-1991?**
    Too few takers to comment.

11. **Was US policy in the Middle East a success, 1945-1991?**
    A number of relatively detailed, balanced answers, with a few very strong essays showing strong knowledge of the major elements of US policy in the Middle East. Many answers would have profited from considering more reflectively what 'success' constituted for US policy, not so much in terms of what US objectives were, but what the reasonable expectations for outcomes were and thus where the burden for relative 'success' lay.

12. **Did the failure of the war in Vietnam demonstrate the flaws in the policy of containment?**
    Several answers, whose quality was generally dictated by how far candidates appreciated the link between the Vietnam intervention and important strategic ambiguities in containment regarding vital interests, resolve and the flexibility of the need to contain. Many brought in US beliefs in 'the domino effect', but a few candidates used this too mechanically, or saw this as exhausting the relevance of containment policy to Vietnam rather than offering deeper exploration of the strategic dilemma Vietnam posed the US. A few weaker answers drifted off the Vietnam-containment link entirely in favour of listing

(presumably better revised) determinants of US failure, or were generally lacking in empirical and theoretical detail.

214 International Relations

There were 136 candidates taking the 214 International Relations paper in 2017 (111 in PPE and 25 in History and Politics), making it again one of the most popular core papers available to Politics candidates.

The general standard was very commendable on the whole, with some outstanding answers at the top end, a very solid range of upper second class answers, and only a relatively small tail of weaker answers (lower seconds in most cases). The best answers combined an effective focus on the question with fluency of writing, a sound knowledge of the relevant literature, a creative and analytical engagement with the different theoretical approaches, while also drawing on a wide set of contemporary empirical examples.

1. "Power is the most essential and the most elusive concept in the IR tool kit". Do you agree?

A fairly popular question, with some good answers, although few grappled effectively with the "elusiveness"; there were also a good range of empirical illustrations.

2. Either "Far from uniting it, globalisation is producing an increasingly fragmented world". Discuss.

A quite popular question, with a decent range of illustrations; the best answers attempted to offer a synthesis which went beyond the dichotomy offered in the question; the weaker answers failed to define globalisation clearly enough.

Or

"The co-operation produced by international institutions has done little to alter the essentially anarchic nature of the international order". Discuss.

The standard of the answers was reasonable, but most contented themselves with summarising the literature, without engaging analytically with it.

3. By what criteria can we assess who benefits from international trade?

Not a popular question, but those who attempted it discussed the issue intelligently.

4. How effective has the UN been in promoting a less state-centric and more comprehensive ideal of global security?

A fairly popular question, with the best answers showing mastery both of the literature on human security and the specific cases of intervention.

5. "Since the sources of ethno-nationalist conflict are rooted in local particularisms, no general theory of ethno-nationalist conflict is possible". Discuss.

Not many takers for this question, but some of the answers were quite strong, attempting to define the general and distinctive properties of ethnic nationalism.

6. Has NATO succeeded in establishing a coherent role for itself in the post-Cold War era?

A decent set of answers for the most part, highlighting the ways in which the organisation has adapted itself to the new security challenges; the best answers also integrated theoretical elements (e.g. constructivism and neo-realism)

7. "The importance of material forces is overerestimated by realists, and underestimated by constructivists". Discuss.

Not a very popular question, but it drew some of the most sophisticated answers, highlighting the fault lines in both approaches.

8. "Despite its flaws, democratic peace theory offers more insights into the causes of war than any of the available alternatives". Discuss.

Most answers tended to recite the standard account of the strengths and weaknesses of democratic peace theory, without sufficiently considering the second part of the question.

9. Does the international society approach provide a coherent account of why states obey international law?

Very few takers for this question, and they were not sufficiently focused on what a coherent account might look like.

10. Has Huntington's theory of the "clash of civilisations" become a self-fulfilling prophecy?

A popular question, with the best answers drawing on social constructivist approaches, and exploring the ideological distortions of Islam in the West.

11. Is the ideal of international distributive justice merely another form of western imperialism?

Very few takers for this question.

12. Has the nature of international conflict fundamentally changed since the end of the Cold War?

A fairly popular question, with the best answers critically assessing the new war literature, and attempting to examine the violence of non-state actors in historical perspective.

215 Political Thought: Plato to Rousseau

24 candidates (22 PPE; 2 HP)

Overall, answers indicated a good knowledge and understanding of the primary texts. In general better answers addressed all parts of the question in a readily identifiable, integrated, coherent answer. The best answers came from candidates who had obviously given some careful thought to the structure of their essays. Within the argumentative structure they set up, they were able to strategically pull in specific evidence from their reading to make their case avoiding overly descriptive or narrative accounts of texts. Weaker answers either made broad generalizations without supporting evidence from the corresponding texts, or provided lists of relevant knowledge about the texts without bringing them together into a coherent answer to the question.

1. ‘Plato’s Republic is not at all a political work, as think those who judge books only by their titles. It is the most beautiful educational treatise ever written.’ (Rousseau) Discuss.

This was a popular question. Answers generally showed a good knowledge of the overall structure of the *Republic*. Most answers had no problem pointing to, and giving evidence for, the centrality of education to the *Republic*. Many wanted to take a position against the quote that the *Republic* was in fact a political work as well, but had difficulty nailing down a precise and coherent account of what actually made it political. The best answers were able to provide a coherent account not only of the educational and political aspects of the *Republic* but of the relationship between them.

2. Explain and evaluate Aristotle’s claim that the polis is ‘prior’ to the human being.

There were relatively few answers. Some answers interpreted the priority of the community over the individual as consisting in a kind of inequality in dependency - i.e., the individual cannot live without the community but not vice versa. Better answers tried to provide more nuanced accounts focused on the conditions of individual flourishing.

3. How does Aquinas attempt to adapt Aristotelian political theory to a Medieval Christian world? Does he succeed?

There were too few answers to comment on.

4. What obstacles does Machiavelli identify to the revival of republican liberty in the modern world? Can they be overcome?

Most candidates who answered this question were able to come up with plausible lists of what Machiavelli considered the major obstacles to the revival of republican liberty backed up by textual support. Better answers also considered the meaning of ‘republican liberty’ and properly tackled the second part of the question, on whether and how these obstacles might be overcome.

5. What role does man’s equality ‘by nature’ play in Hobbes’s civil science? As he presents it, is the premise persuasive?

Better answers gave a precise definition of what Hobbes meant by equal ‘by nature’ (and how that equality may not necessarily correspond to an intuitive notion of what equality might be for us). In giving an account of the significance of equality for Hobbes’ civil science, some answers only offered a narrative of the transition from state of nature to civil society. Better answers were more selective in drawing on this narrative and clearer in specifying what Hobbes’s civil science was. They also took clearer positions in evaluating whether the premise of equality was convincing.

6. ‘To understand Political Power right, and derive from it its Original, we must consider what State all men are naturally in…’ Why does Locke make this claim? Is he right?

Most answers showed awareness, in varying degrees of philosophical subtlety, of the state of nature as a theoretical device. Better answers were able to frame Locke’s recourse to the state of nature exercise as a response to a particular political theoretical problem (political legitimacy). These answers would reconstruct the problem, show how the state of nature exercise helps answer it, and evaluate limitations/problems with this approach.

7. ‘Montesquieu is the founder of modern social science.’ Discuss.

There were too few answers to comment on.

8. What is ‘luxury’, and how does it contribute to moral and political progress, according to Hume?

There were relatively few answers to this question but these answers showed a good understanding of Hume’s theory and related this in a relevant way to the question.

9. ‘If there were a people of Gods, they would govern themselves democratically. So perfect a Government is not suited to men’ (Rousseau). Discuss.

This was quite a popular question. Better answers noted the key distinction in Rousseau’s theory between Sovereign and government and were able to connect the quote to this distinction. On this basis they were able to resolve the apparent tension between the quote and Rousseau’s theory of Sovereignty. Weaker answers did not note this distinction and consequently struggled more to get a handle on the question.

10. ‘Lower than heaven, but far above the smoke and stir of this known world’. How acute is this as a description of the ‘best regime’ or ideal state according to at least TWO of the authors you have studies [sic] for this paper.

This was a popular question. All answers were able to identify what was at stake in the question in terms of the nature and merits of ‘ideal’ political theory (including, but not necessarily exclusive to, what is typically categorised as ‘utopian’ theory). Better answers selected authors strategically to answer the question.

11. Discuss the relationship between religion and politics in the work of TWO of the following: Aquinas, Hobbes, Locke, or Montesquieu.

This question generated well-informed and relevant answers with a pronounced focus on Hobbes and Locke of the four indicated authors.

12. Critically evaluate the role slavery plays in the political thought of ONE OR MORE of the authors you have studied for this paper.

This question generated some thoughtful answers based on close and critical readings of primary texts (e.g., Aristotle, Locke).

216 Political Thought: Bentham to Weber

23 candidates (20 PPE; 3 HP)

In general, candidates taking this paper displayed a solid understanding of the views of the prescribed authors. However, that knowledge was not always grounded in a close familiarity with the primary texts, and weaker candidates in particular were heavily reliant on secondary literature and lectures. Weaker candidates were also typically less good at manipulating the knowledge they had in order to answer the precise questions asked. Future candidates would be well advised to study the primary texts directly, and to attend closely to the specifics of the exam questions.

1. **In what ways was Saint-Simon's thought an attempt to confront the French Revolution?**

   Candidates typically showed some good knowledge of Saint-Simon's writings, but the attempts to link it to the French Revolution were less convincing.

2. **'Pain and pleasure at least are words which a man has no need, we may hope, to go to a Lawyer to know the meaning of.' (Bentham). What's the significance of this for Bentham's political theory?**

   [Too few answers to comment on.]

3. **What role does recognition play in Hegel's political theory?**

   Few candidates appreciated the role that recognition is sometimes held to play in Hegel's *Rechtsphilosophie.*

4. **What is the relationship, for Marx, between the end of capitalism and political revolution?**

   Weaker answers tended not to disambiguate the concept of 'revolution' sufficiently. Relatedly, some better answers focused on the place of *political* revolution in Marx's thought.

5. **'Democracy in America is a book about France.' Is it?**

   Most candidates recognised the complexity of this issue, but sometimes struggled to find a structure to organise that complexity.

6. **Does Mill's theory of civilisation undermine his liberalism?**

   The most popular question. Better answers understood that 'undermine' is a strong requirement, that Mill limits the liberty principle to adults in civilised societies, and that writings other than *On Liberty* might be relevant here.

7. **How did Weber explain the growth of bureaucracy and why was he so concerned about it?**

   Some good Weber knowledge was demonstrated, although not all candidates addressed the 'explanatory' part of the question (not everyone gave very clear and accurate accounts of Weber's explanation of rationalisation, for example).

8. **'It is not from within himself that can come the external pressure which he undergoes; it is therefore not what is happening within himself which can explain it.' (Durkheim). Discuss.**

   Candidates confirmed that the relation between social ontology and method in Durkheim's

work is a difficult and sometimes obscure one.

9. **Was the individual sacrificed to the community in the political thought of the long nineteenth century? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.**

   A popular question. Lots of interesting answers, although the concept of 'community' was not always clarified very carefully.

10. **Do states have a destiny and if so, how can it be discovered? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.**

    Not all candidates were able to give clear and persuasive accounts of what having a 'destiny' might involve.

11. **'The science of politics is yet to be created. This is the burden of modernity.' Discuss in relation to TWO or more prescribed authors.**

    [Too few answers to comment on.]

12. **Why were political theorists in the long nineteenth century concerned with women and the family? Answer with reference to at least TWO of the prescribed authors.**

    Some good knowledge here, but candidates often struggled with the specifics of the question. Some needed to think more about why their chosen authors had addressed these issues; what was driving their concerns here.

217 Marx and Marxism

23 candidates (20 PPE; 3 HP)

In general, candidates had a good knowledge of the central ideas and arguments of Marx and Engels' writings. Stronger candidates were typically better at using that knowledge to answer the precise question, and showed a greater familiarity with the primary texts. Textual knowledge was typically less evident in answers on 'the later Marxists' (Bernstein, Luxemburg, etc.). The most common formal weakness, as ever, was of candidates failing to attend carefully to the specifics of the question.

1. **What is the most persuasive part of Marx's critique of Hegel?**

   [Too few answers to comment on.]

2. **Is Marx right to think that capitalists, as well as proletarians, are alienated?**

There were some interesting attempts to identify different forms, or aspects, of alienation, in order to answer the question. Not all candidates appeared aware of places where Marx addresses something like this issue (including a comparatively well-known passage from *The Holy Family*).

3. **'Marx does not possess a fully developed class theory; his work in this domain is full of ambiguity and evasion.' Discuss.**

   The specific complaints here – that Marx's work is evasive and ambiguous – were not always addressed with sufficient precision.

4. **EITHER: What is the relation between Marx's theory of history and his conception of human nature?**

   In general, candidates were more confident in elucidating Marx's theory of history than in explaining its contested relation to his account of human nature. The variety of possible relations here was not always appreciated.

   OR: 'Marx's various claims about "base and superstructure" are unclear and unhelpful.' Discuss.

   Some good answers here, with clear and cogent identification and discussion of the issues.

5. **'The question then arises: What transformation will the state undergo in a communist society?' Does Marx ever satisfactorily answer his own question?**

   Some good answers here, although some candidates seem to have thought that a 'satisfactory' answer was a low hurdle to clear.

6. **Are all 'false and misleading' ideas 'ideological' for Marx?**

   Not a very popular question, but some good answers which acknowledged the difficulty of identifying Marx's view of ideology.

7. **'The crucial difference between Marx and the utopian socialists is that whereas the former rejected the need for socialist design, the latter always thought of the socialist future in an experimental and open-ended way.' Discuss.**

   Good candidates spotted that the need for socialist design, and an experimental approach, might be distinct things. Encouragingly, first hand familiarity with utopian socialist writings was a little more in evidence than in some previous years.

8. **'Accounts of Marx as a critic of all morality fail to appreciate that the needs principle – "From each according to their ability, to each according to their need" – is a principle of distributive justice.' Discuss.**

The most popular question. Some good discussion of the broader issues here, but candidates were not always very clear about the *content* of 'the needs principle' despite the existence of good secondary discussions by Pablo Gilabert, Joseph Carens, Stuart White, and others.

9. **'Bernstein was building on certain elements in the writings of Marx and Engels, and not simply rejecting their ideas completely.' Discuss.**

   Some solid answers here, but first hand familiarity with Bernstein's writings was not always very evident.

10. **'Rosa Luxemburg's life was undoubtedly dramatic, but her theoretical legacy was slight.' Discuss.**

    First-hand knowledge of primary texts was often slight, and not all candidates were aware of the breadth of Luxemburg's theoretical interests beyond issues of party and class (the national question, the accumulation of capital, and much more).

11. **In making a socialist revolution in economically-backwards Russia were the Bolsheviks acting in conformity with, or against, Marx's own views?**

    It is encouraging to see that many candidates aware of the later Marx's engagement with Russian economic development and political prospects, especially, but not only, in his notebooks and correspondence. Some answers, however, did not show sufficient knowledge of Bolshevik theory regarding these issues.

12. **To what problem is Gramsci's account of 'hegemony' intended to be a solution?**

    Some solid understanding of Gramsci's ideas was demonstrated, but familiarity with primary texts was not always much in evidence.

218 Sociological Theory

14 candidates (13 PPE; 1 HP)

Quality ranged from acceptable, to good (second class) to outstanding (first class). The best scripts demonstrated impressive breadth of reading and depth of analysis. The spread for the other questions was as follows: 4 candidates for Q1 (violence); 2 candidates for Q2 (filtering mechanisms); 6 candidates for Q3 (cooperation); 6 candidates for Q4 (social norms); 1 candidate for Q5 (free-riding); 1 candidate for Q6 (totalitarianism); 2 candidates for Q7 (ethnicity); 5 candidates for Q8 (gender); 4 candidates for Q9 (mafia/state), 8 candidates for Q10 (social capital/network); 2 candidates for Q11 (social structure); 1 candidate for Q12 (Prisoners' Dilemma). The assessors noted that the spread of answers is better than last year.

219 The Sociology of Post-Industrial Societies

There were four PPE and one History & Politics candidate for this paper. Almost all of the questions were attempted. All candidates achieved an upper-second. All the scripts demonstrated breadth of reading but none went much beyond making a compilation of extant views. Competently reporting what various parties have said is fine, but at some point one might venture an opinion about what is correct, especially when some of the views contradict each other.

The number of candidates is so small that it is profitless to draw any further conclusions.

220 Political Sociology

71 candidates (62 PPE; 9 HP) (including 9 PPE as old rubric)

Answers this year were generally very good. It was striking the extent to which many candidates achieved very high 2.1 marks but relatively few had the depth of knowledge combined with the analytical sophistication required to secure first class marks. Happily, there were relatively few marks below 65 this year.

The variation in marks overwhelmingly (and fortunately) appeared to be the product of differences in how much people knew and understood about the relevant literature, rather than problems with exam technique. There were relatively few issues specific to particular questions, but the main ones are outlined below.

1. **Is democracy undermined more by critical citizenship or by alienation?**

   There were relatively few answers to this question and the most common source of weakness was not knowing enough about the idea of critical citizenship. The best answers showed an understanding of the classics (especially Almond and Verba) as well as the most contemporary research.

2. **Is the salience of immigration and ethnicity in electoral politics primarily the result of economic factors?**

   This was a popular question but many answers failed to discuss the experience of ethnic minorities. There was also a tendency to ignore the role of parties.

3. **What have female legislators ever done for women?**

   Another popular question that was largely done well. Answers were fairly similar in structure but there was wide variation in how much relevant knowledge candidates could draw on. Some candidates neglected to discuss the evidence on gender gaps in policy preference.

4. **What sustains nationalism?**

   The relative few answers to this question were often insufficiently focused on the question set.

5. **How do the political implications of Islam differ from those of Christianity?**

Answers to this question were relatively weak because candidates apparently found it difficult to compare and contrast the literatures on Christianity and Islam in sensible ways. Surprisingly some candidates completely neglected the issue of violent political action.

6. **Why do people with liberal attitudes tend to be environmentalist and relatively socialist in outlook?**

   Some approached this question solely with knowledge of the post-materialism literature and so did less well than those who were familiar with the items on the reading list on climate change attitudes and environmentalism. The role of parties was frequently neglected.

7. **Does political participation in rich democracies depend more on who you are or who you talk to?**

   Answers varied in quality both according to knowledge of the literature and in the degree of structure and analysis. Those who showed knowledge of the participation literature beyond electoral turnout did better.

8. **Do political elites use power for personal gain more than for democratic governance?**

   There were too few answers to this question to comment.

9. **Do welfare states depend mainly on social solidarity?**

   Answers to this question tended to be relatively good, except that they often neglected some of the social attitudes literature.

10. **Does the academic literature on media effects suggest that fake news can be highly influential?**

    This was a very popular question, for which the answers were generally very thoughtful. Weaker answers tended to opine on fake news without much evaluation of the academic literature.

11. **'Ethnic violence in civil wars is primarily the result of economic factors.' Discuss.**

    There were not many answers to this question. Those that there were were typically done well.

12. **Why did the process of state formation through tax and war vary from country to country?**

    There were too few answers to this question to comment.

223 The Government and Politics of Japan

4 candidates (all PPE)

Questions answered: Q1 -3, Q2-1, Q4-1, Q5-1, Q6-1, Q9-3, Q12-2

As usual the questions on the occupation and foreign policy which can be confidently expected to appear attracted the most answers. Overall the results ranged between 63-73. The students revised together so it is not surprising that there was this clustering.

224 Social Policy

21 candidates (16 PPE; 5 HP)

Note that the totals and comments below do not include analysis of answers by the 2 human sciences students taking the exam, as a separate exam report is submitted for human sciences. There were fewer candidates taking the examination this year compared with last year.

The scripts this year were again generally of a high standard, with a few outstanding answers. The questions answered by more candidates this year comprised one from the first section of the course (which introduces students to key social policy/welfare state concepts and issues), concerning the welfare mix (13 answers), and one from the second section (on more specific policy areas) (12 answers, about education). These were by a significant margin the two most popular questions, and cover areas that have proved consistently of interest to candidates over time. Fewer, but always more than four, candidates answered questions on the policy-making process; the emergence of the welfare state in the UK; and welfare regimes/typologising. The last of these is usually a very popular question, but was relatively less so this year; it does not always attract high quality responses, however, as there is a tendency to repeat certain stock elements regardless of their relevance to the question in hand.

There was a more even spread of answers this year than has often been the case. All questions were answered by at least one candidate. Only one question, on the statutory national minimum wage, had only one taker. The other questions (on family policy, housing, intergenerational justice, health care and immigration) had more, but relatively few, answers. Immigration is a recent addition to the course, replacing area based analysis and policies; housing is in essence a sub-topic, as the other element of that section is about homelessness.

The most popular questions were:
* 3. ‘To what extent do recent changes in the “mixed economy of welfare” in the UK vary between different policy areas of the welfare state? Draw on two or more policy areas as examples.’
* 2. ‘Has education policy in the UK over recent years been an area of consensus or of conflict, and why?’
* 1. ‘Is poverty still a relevant concern for social policy in the UK today?’
* 5. ‘”Choosing a policy solution to a social problem is more the result of the preconceived ideas of policy-makers than the end result of a rational process”. How far do you agree?’
* 8. ‘To what extent was the emergence of the welfare state in the UK an inevitable result of industrialisation?’
* 10. ‘Is it only possible to explain recent policy developments across different welfare states by examining specific policy areas?’

This year many scripts were impressive, outlining well-structured arguments which drew on referenced evidence to support them and displaying a thoughtful approach to the question. The interpretation of ‘recent’ (as in ‘recent policy developments’) varies, although the course outline

suggests that this should usually be understood as comprising the period since 1979. Departures from this can of course be acceptable if a good argument is advanced to justify them in the case in question.

However, there were also this year some answers seeking to answer the question that the candidate wished to have seen, rather than the actual question on the paper. Other less good quality answers tended to rely on statements about the issue at stake without substantiating these with evidence.

High quality answers, however, discussed theory as well as evidence when this was appropriate. Commendably, more students this year also included in their answers consideration of how the questions related to devolution where relevant, though the potential impact of 'Brexit' is not yet apparent in answers (understandably, as this will not have been taught in tutorials, since there is as yet little information about how it will affect social policy). The best scripts combined nuanced analysis and thorough knowledge of central social policy ideas, specific policy issues or both, and made use of relevant literature and sometimes statistics to put forward an answer which demonstrated clear and critical thinking.

The number of takers for each question was as follows:

Q	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
No.	6	12	13	4	5	2	3	5	1	5	4	3

Classification:

DMHP and DPPE scripts combined:

Mark classification	Number of students attaining this
I	5
II.i	12
II.ii	2
III	2

226 Quantitative Methods in Politics and Sociology

1 candidate (PPE)

There were too few candidates to comment on this paper.

227 Politics in China

19 candidates (14 PPE, 5 HP)

There was a fairly good spread of answers this year with takers for almost every one of the questions on the paper. The most popular were questions on the position of women in reform-era China, the rise of popular nationalism, whether China could be considered a status quo power, and whether the internet had diminished or strengthened the influence of Chinese intellectuals over time: unsurprisingly, these key issues in contemporary Chinese political development attracted strong and well thought-through answers, although candidates needed to be wary of not answering a

"standard" answer on the wider topic without thinking about the precise question asked. There were also good answers on the legacy of the Tiananmen Square protests, and more answers than in previous years on the role of "rule of law" in China (which has become increasingly important in the scholarly literature). The question on economic development in the absence of market-preserving institutions proved both popular and surprisingly problematic, as some of the answers mistook "market-preserving institutions" for "market-preserving federalism," but of course the best answers correctly identified the term, its origin, and reviewed the relevant literature on the topic. There was less engagement with questions of political reform – admittedly a very fast-changing and perhaps ambiguous subject in contemporary China- - although this subject will only continue to increase in importance over the next several years. Overall, this was another year of strong answers, the best of which showed careful reading and detailed answers to the major topics covered.

228 The Politics of the European Union

5 candidates (4 PPE, 1HP)

Only an handful of candidates took the paper this year. Hence, it is impossible to provide a detailed assessment of each individual question without compromising confidentiality. However, generally speaking the quality of answers was very high throughout. Candidates provided focused and well reflected answers to the given questions, mainly on EMU, CFSP, the alleged EU Democratic Deficit and on the various EU Institutions. They showed broad knowledge of the history, theory, institutions and policies of European integrations and applied theories well to empirical examples. Assessors rewarded the fact that such examples were drawn from different periods of European Integration as opposed to a focus on very recent events. The scripts were generally well written and eloquent. All in all, an exceptionally strong year group for this paper.

229 Advanced Paper in Theories of Justice

The paper was taken by 16 PPE students and 2 History and Politics students. The overall performance was very impressive. 10 got 1st class marks, 6 got 2.1s, and 2 got 2.2s. The strongest answers were written with considerable authority, and the candidates showed that they were in complete command of their material. They not only displayed a deep grasp of the normative issues and the relevant literature, but also had their own distinctive take on the issues examined, and were willing and able to set out and defend their own point of view.

Q1. Assess the view that international trade is just to the extent that the benefits of trade are shared equally.
[4 answers] The best answers showed an excellent grasp of the arguments made by thinkers like Aaron James and raised probing objections. The strongest ones also discussed the question of whether one can determine whether international trade is just or not without drawing on a more general theory of justice.

Q2. How should we strike a balance between the rights of political communities to be self-determining and the rights of individuals to freedom of movement?
[8 answers] Most answers made sound points and showed a good understanding of the ethical issues at stake. Some focused more on the first part of the answer and did not say enough on the second part.

Q3. Should the costs of combating climate change be borne by those who have benefited most from industrialization?
[8 answers] This question produced a number of sophisticated and thoughtful answers which displayed a strong grasp of the strengths and weaknesses of the claim that beneficiaries of industrialization should pay for the costs of combating climate change. Some were tempted to make this a general essay on competing principles of justice (so analysed the strengths and weaknesses of the Polluter Pays Principle, Ability to Pay Principle and Beneficiary Pays Principle), rather than one focused specifically on the last one.

Q4. What role, if any, can the duty not to harm others play in an account of people's responsibilities to future generations?
[9 answers] This question also generated a number of high quality answers. The best revealed an impressive grasp of Parfit's Non Identity Problem (including its presuppositions and its theoretical and practical implications) as well as the responses advanced by a variety of different thinkers.

5. Either: (a) 'Justice requires that each generation leave future generations with a standard of living that is at least as high as their own'. Discuss.
Or: (b) Do we owe less to future generations than we owe our contemporaries?
[1 answer]

Q6. In what circumstances, if any, can past injustices become superseded by the passage of time?
[5 answers] These questions produced answers of varying quality. The best answers distinguished between a number of different conditions under which past injustices might be superseded, and the less strong provided general overviews of the literature and were not as focused on directly answering the question.

Q7. 'Given that it is unfair to require some to pay for the wrongdoing of others it is unfair to make those alive today pay for the wrongdoing of their nation before they were born'. Discuss.
[5 answers] Several answers to this were very extremely strong – separating out the two separate aspects of the question, showing a sophisticated grasp of the extant literature and staking out their own point of view in a clear and authoritative way.

Q8. 'The social model of disability is inaccurate and harmful.' Discuss.
[6 answers] The strongest answers distinguished between different disabilities, and combined a good grasp of the philosophical literature with a strong empirically informed understanding of different disabilities. Some answers focused much on the first part of the question, paying insufficient attention to the second part.

Q9. Can contractarian theories of justice give an adequate account of the claims of those with disabilities?
[1 answer]

Q10. Evaluate the claim that the costs of bringing up a child should be borne by that child's parents.

[3 answers] This was well answered, and provided thoughtful assessments of the arguments commonly presented for and against this claim. Some contented themselves with an overview of the literature. The best went beyond this and set out their own distinctive point of view.

Q11. What moral rights, if any, do infants possess?
[4 answers] The answers to this question varied quite a bit in terms of their quality. More generally, the answers could have said more about how they were conceptualizing being an 'infant'.

Q12. 'Compassion, not justice, grounds our duties to the most vulnerable'. Discuss.
No students answered this.

297 Special Subject in Politics: Comparative Political Economy

11 candidates (10 PPE; 1 HP)

11 students sat the exam for Comparative Political Economy. The overall quality of the scripts was high, with students nearly uniformly showing strong command of the material.

The most popular questions covered the 'equity-efficiency' tradeoff, the development of the welfare state, 'Varieties of Capitalism,' banking systems and economic crisis. The number of scripts is too small to offer comments on individual questions. Overall, the best scripts offered a careful and extensive discussion of both the empirical and theoretical material. These scripts tended to discuss both a large amount of empirical material, and assess the quality of the evidence in detail (e.g. provide details on how various authors reached their conclusions and made assessments on the validity of these claims). The stronger scripts also tended cover a broader range of material. The weaker scripts displayed strong competence with the material, but were more formulaic in their analysis or lacked breadth.

297 Special Subject in Politics: International Security and Conflict

Answers were generally of a high standard, with numerous first class awards and no 2.2 grades. No special issues arose during the examination itself. A total of 22 students took this paper in FHS 2017 – 18 PPE students and 4 HP students. Comments on individual questions below (number of answers for each question in brackets).

1. **How significant is the linkage between the security of women and the security of states?** (1)

   Too few answers to comment.

2. **Are realist explanations of the causes of interstate war the best ones?** (11)

   A very popular question, perhaps unsurprisingly given its links back to familiar paper from the IR core course. The weakest answers failed to go much beyond the core course and lacked clear engagement with the specific causes of war literature of this topic for this paper, but most successfully engaged with a deeper range of both realist and non-realist ideas and research. Most answers were held back somewhat by a tendency to simply argue

that everything/a huge range of things matter in the causes of war, rather than think about how these causes can be prioritised or integrated into effective explanations, or consider when factors meet the threshold of explanatory relevance. Some strong answers effectively considered what might back an explanation 'best'.

3. **What does a regional perspective contribute to the analysis of national and international security?** (2)

   Too few answers to infer much.

4. **Can the outbreak of civil war be explained by material factors alone?** (12)

   The most popular question producing answers of very varying quality. Almost all students, even in stronger answers, struggled to really assess the explanatory relevance of different factors – tending to infer that if, for example, ideology or identity was in some way 'present' in civil wars this meant it was important – and, as with Q2, many answers descended into lists of different causes without much consideration of how to build effective explanations. Stronger answers concretely prioritised some factors over others, and several students showed detailed and excellent understanding of the academic literature on this topic, as well as good use of some key examples.

5. **'States acquire weapons of mass destruction in order not to have to use them.' Do you agree?** (4)

   A couple of strong answers, but clear and detailed discussions of the actual logics of deterrence that underpin the question were surprisingly hard to find. Candidates were better in summarising the various major explanations for the pursuit of weapons of mass destruction, but almost all answers would have been improved by more extensive discussion of the deterrent motive specifically. Reference to specific examples could also have been stronger.

6. **How important is religion in explaining early twenty-first century terrorism?** (7)

   A popular question which broadly yielded good answers – though there was, as in many questions, a tendency to adopt somewhat vague or banal conclusions to the effect that religion matters somewhat but not exclusively. The strongest answers identified different parts of the causal chain behind terrorist violence where religion might mattered and interrogated leading models of how it might do so. One or two answers lapsed into very simplistic considerations of religion, but broadly conceptualization was good – and many answers noted the presence of strands of 21st Century terrorism not bound up with religious fundamentalism at all.

7. **Is identity a cause of genocide and mass killing?** (8)

Again, a popular question that tended to produce somewhat hedged answers – almost all students suggested that identity does matter but not exclusively, and several struggled to offer a more precise and revealing analysis. As in Q4, there was also difficulty in assessing identity's explanatory relevance – the tendency was to argue that where it seems visible, it is a cause. A few struggled to include more than one or two major examples. Better answers went into some detail on where exactly identity fits into the processes that produce genocide and mass killing, and surveyed different competing accounts of its role, dismissing some and embracing others.

8. **How does the large-scale displacement of human beings exacerbate armed conflict?** (9)

   A popular question generating some high quality answers which unpacked a number of key links through which displacement affects armed conflict. The strongest answers went into detail on the causal mechanisms involved and deployed a broad range of cases as evidence. Weaker answers descended into rather shallow lists of effects, and/or lacked reference to real world cases.

9. **Is the widespread perpetration of sexual violence by armed groups in war mainly a product of certain kinds of armed groups or certain kinds of war?** (3)

   A small number of reflective and relatively sophisticated answers, but candidates sometimes struggled to address the specific dialectic in the question, veering into a broader reproduction of causal factors reproduced from some of the readings. Most answers would have benefited from more empirical illustration and comparative reference to cases.

10. **How does transnational organized crime jeopardise domestic governance?** (2)

    Too few answers to comment.

11. **Can existing international and regional institutions resolve major problems of cybersecurity?** (1)

    Too few answers to comment.

12. **When do peace operations fail?** (6)

Some good answers bringing in a wide-ranging and diverse literature and showing good knowledge of the key current wisdom on how peace operations should and should not be designed. The best answers systematically surveyed different kinds of designs for/critiques of peace operations and distilled key conclusions from that survey and brought in a broad range of key cases/examples. Weaker answers tended towards relatively banal conclusions, and/or lacked detailed reference to examples